

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Deserve Better

A Journal for Healing Friendship Betrayal



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · for broken trust

WELCOME

Before You Begin



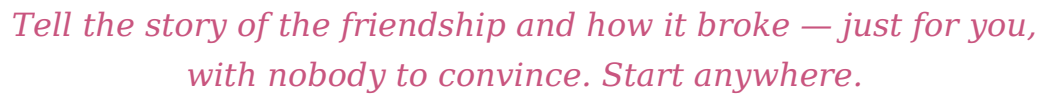
Nobody warns you that a friend can break your heart
worse than any romance. There's no word for this breakup,
no sympathy cards, no playlist. Just you, blindsided,
wondering what was real.

This journal takes friendship loss as seriously as it deserves.

These pages will help you sort what happened, grieve what
was real, and rebuild your trust — starting with trust in you.

Go one page at a time. Some questions will sting.
That's the splinter coming out, not going in.

What Happened



PART ONE

The Blindside



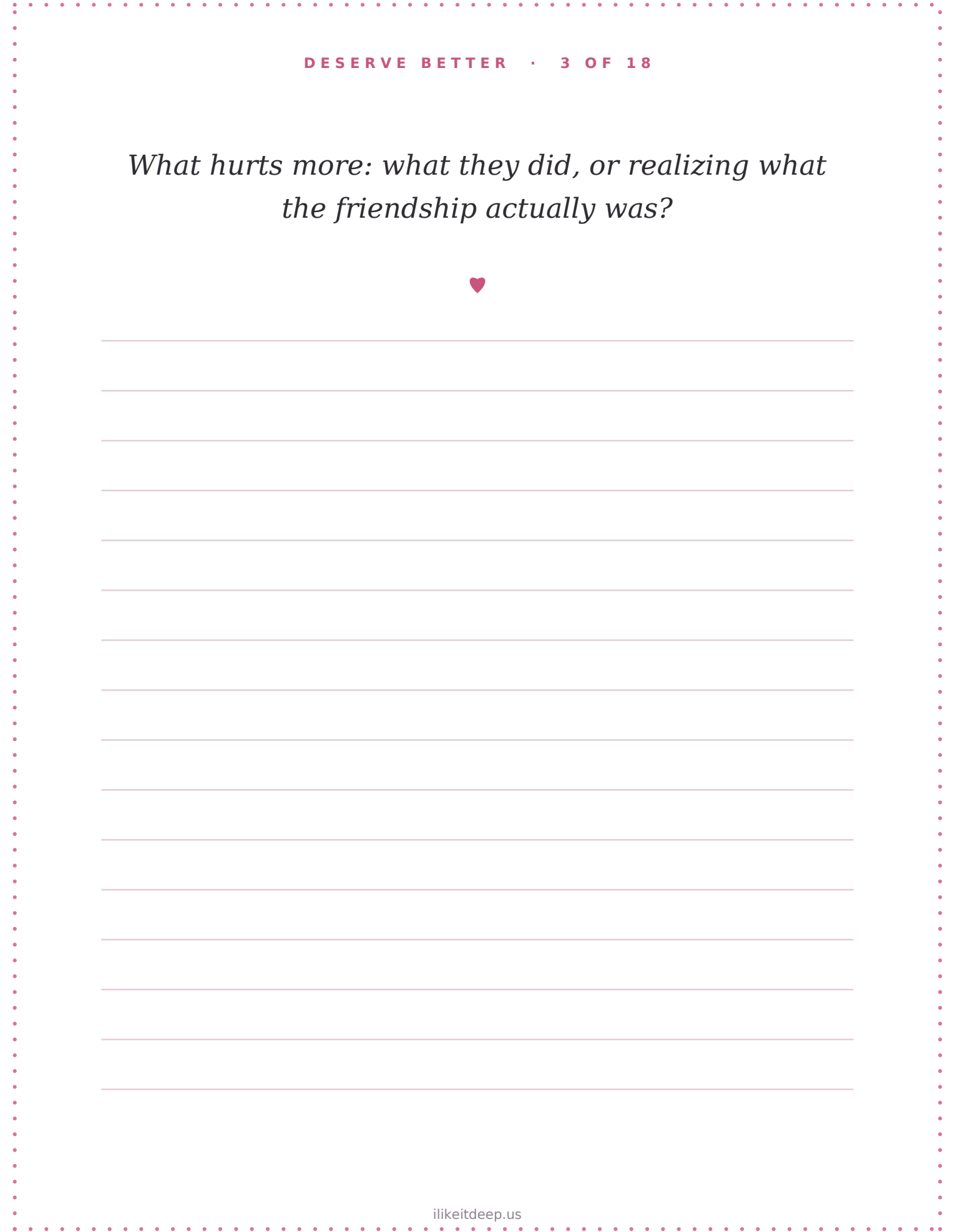
*Friendship grief is real grief. Stop minimizing
it — the hurt is telling the truth.*

What exactly did they do — and what did it mean to you beyond the act itself?



What are you feeling about it right now? Anger, grief, embarrassment, relief — list it all.

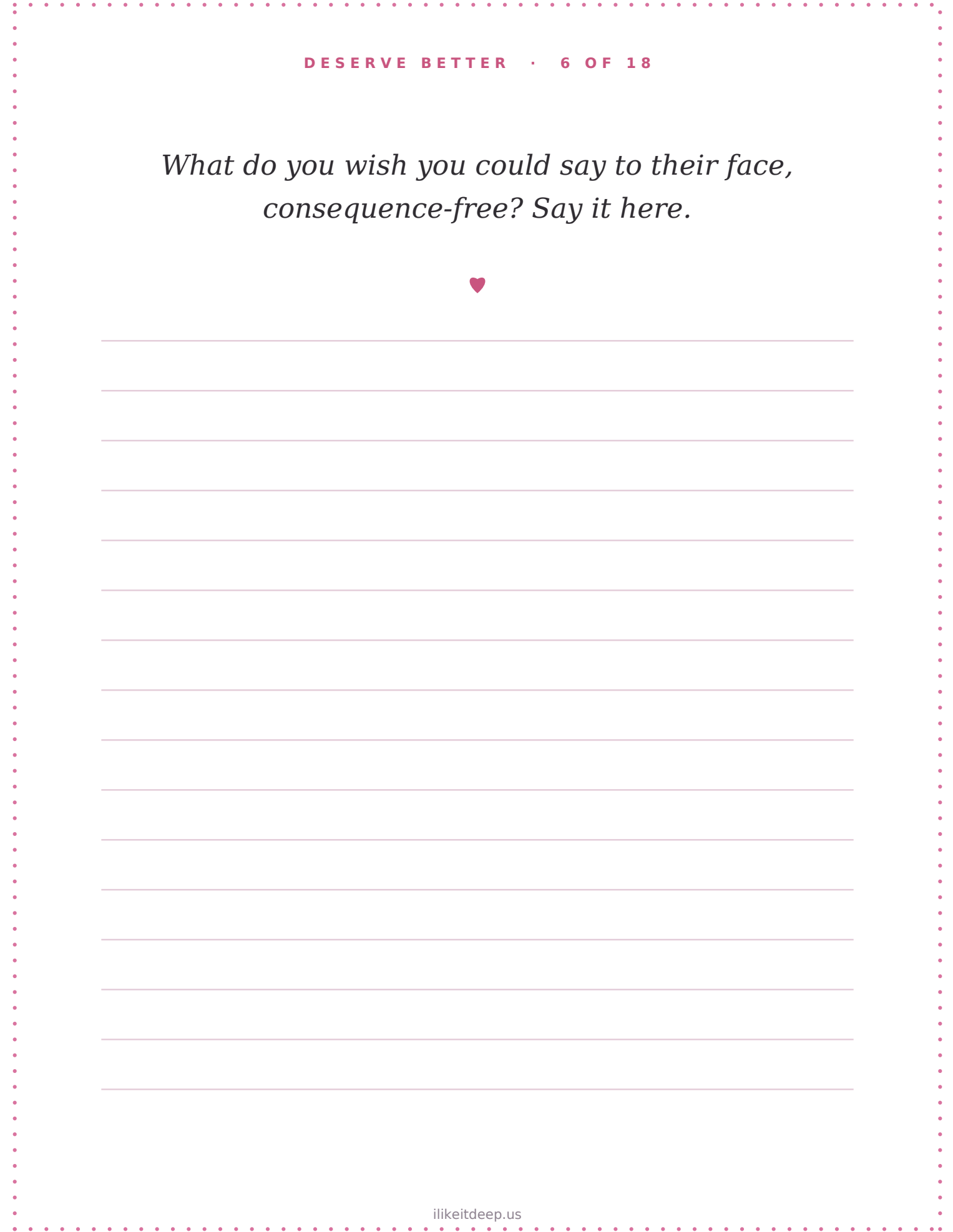


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What moments do you keep replaying, and what are you searching for in them?





[illegible][illegible]

PART TWO

What Was Real



*You're not foolish for trusting. You were being
a friend. They weren't.*

What signs did you talk yourself out of noticing? Not to blame yourself — to honor your gut.



[illegible][illegible]

What role did you play for them — and what role did they actually play for you?



Which memories were real and good? You're allowed to keep those, even now.



*What did their choice reveal about their character
— not yours?*



If your daughter or best friend had been treated this exact way, what would you tell her?



PART THREE

Raising the Standard



*'Deserve better' isn't a mood. It's a policy.
Write yours.*

What does a safe, real friend actually look like to you now? Get specific.



What are your new non-negotiables in friendship — the things you'll never talk yourself out of again?



*Who in your life right now already treats you well?
Name them and what they do.*



What kind of friend do you want to be — and where do you want to invest that energy now?



What would it look like to stay open-hearted without being unguarded?



Write a short goodbye to the friendship — not to send, just to close the door with your own hand.



When They Come Back Around



Fake friends often circle back. Check the responses you're keeping in your pocket.

- ☐ I don't owe an explanation for my distance
- ☐ A reply can wait a day — or forever
- ☐ 'I wish you well' is a complete sentence
- ☐ No relitigating the past to someone who rewrites it
- ☐ Mutual friends don't get a vote on my boundaries
- ☐ Screenshot-worthy behavior gets zero reaction from me
- ☐ I can be polite and still be closed
- ☐ An apology without changed behavior is just a performance
- ☐ I don't shrink my joy to keep their comfort
- ☐ If it costs my peace, it's too expensive

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Proof I'm a Good Friend



Their betrayal doesn't get to define your friendship résumé. Log the loyal things you've done and the good friends who remain.

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



Losing a friend this way rearranges something in you.

Let it rearrange you toward higher standards,
not higher walls.

The right people won't make you do detective work
to feel safe. You'll know them by how rested
your heart feels around them.

You didn't lose a good friend.

You lost an illusion — and found your standard.



*You didn't ask for too much. You asked
the wrong person.*



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